

① Image Enhancement in the Spatial Domain

Definition: Image enhancement in the spatial domain refers to improving the visual quality of an image by directly modifying the pixel values. The main objective is to make the image more suitable for human observation or further image processing.

Gray-Level Transformation

Gray-level transformation modifies the intensity values of pixels.

Types:

Image Negative: Reverses brightness values, useful in medical imaging.

Log Transformation: Enhances dark regions.

Power-law Transformation: Adjusts brightness and contrast.

Contrast Stretching: Expands intensity range to improve visibility.

Advantages:

* Simple and fast

* Improves brightness and contrast.

② Image Smoothing vs Image Sharpening.

Image Smoothing

Image smoothing reduces noise by averaging neighboring pixels.

Working principle: A smoothing filter replaces the center pixel with the average or weighted average of surrounding pixels.

Types:

- mean filter
- Gaussian filter
- median filter

Advantages

- Removes random noise.
- Produces smooth images.

Limitations

- Blurs edges.
- Reduces fine details.

Image Sharpening:

Types:

- Laplacian filter
- Sobel filter
- Prewitt filter

Advantages:

- Enhances edges.
- Improves feature visibility.

Limitation: may amplify noise.

③ Image Enhancement in Frequency Domain

Definition

Frequency domain enhancement processes images after converting them into the frequency domain using the Fourier Transform.

Steps:

1. Convert image using Fourier Transform.
2. Apply Frequency filter.
3. Perform Inverse Fourier Transform.
4. Obtain enhanced image.

Low-Pass Filter (LPF)

Working:

- Passes low-frequency components.
- Blocks high-frequency components.

Effects:

- Smooths the image.
- Removes noise.

Applications

- Fingerprint recognition.
- Industrial inspection.
- OCR.

Advantages:

- Efficient for large images.
- Provides better control over enhancement.

④ Image Segmentation

Definition

Image segmentation divides an image into meaningful regions for easier analysis.

Technique

1. Point Detection

Detect isolated pixels with different intensity.

Application:

- Fault detection.
- Medical imaging.

2. Line Detection

Detect horizontal, vertical, and diagonal lines.

Application

- Road detection.
- Text recognition.

3. Edge Detection

Detect boundaries using intensity change.

Methods

- Sobel
- Prewitt
- Canny

Application

- Object recognition
- Face detection.

⑤ Edge detection, Edge Linking and Boundary Detection.

Edge Detection:

Edge detection identifies sudden changes in image intensity

methods

- Sobel
- Prewitt
- Roberts
- Canny

Importance

- Detects object boundaries.
- Reduces unnecessary information.

Edge Linking.

Edge linking connects broken edge pixels into continuous edges.

methods

- Hough Transform
- Graph-based method

Importance

- Produces complete object outline.
- Improves segmentation.